

Global Renewable Energy in 2025: How Far Have We Come?

A data-driven overview of renewable energy's growing share
in the global energy and electricity mix.

Source: Our World in Data – Renewable Energy

75% of Global GHG Emissions Still Come from Fossil Fuels

The Urgency: Why Renewables Matter

Since the Industrial Revolution, the world's energy systems have been dominated by fossil fuels, driving climate change.

75%

of global greenhouse gas emissions
come from burning fossil fuels.

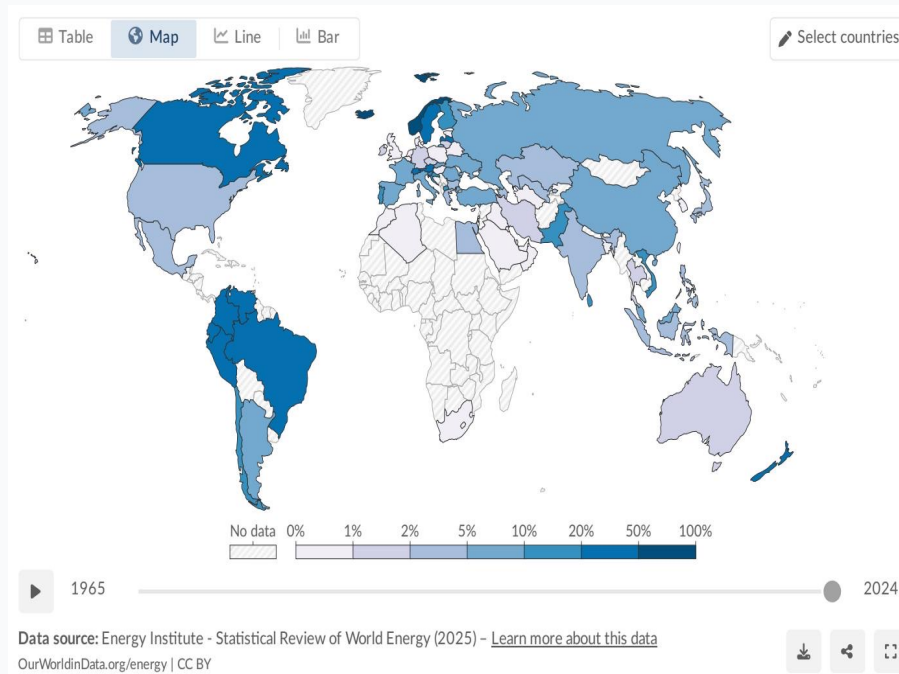
5 Million+

premature deaths per year
caused by local air pollution.

To reduce emissions, the world must rapidly shift toward low-carbon energy sources.

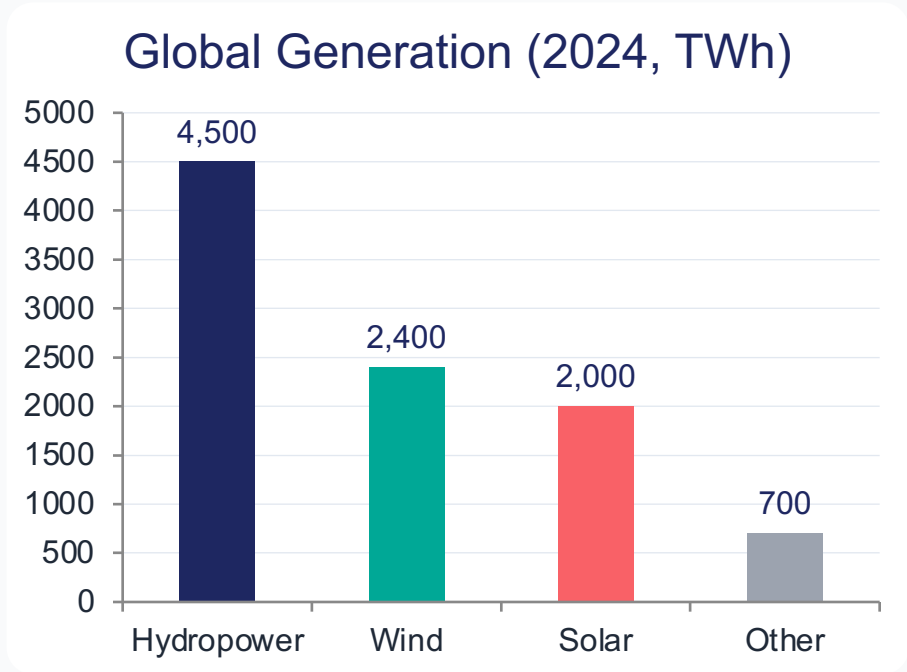
Renewables Now Supply ~14% of Global Primary Energy

- Approximately one-seventh (~14%) of the world's primary energy now comes from renewable technologies (2024 data, substitution method).
- Primary energy encompasses electricity, transport, and heating combined.
- Transport and heating are harder to decarbonize, keeping the total primary energy renewable share lower than the electricity mix.



Renewable Electricity Generation Is Growing Rapidly, Led by Wind and Solar

- Acceleration in wind and solar since ~2010.
- Wind and solar combined now nearly match hydropower's output.



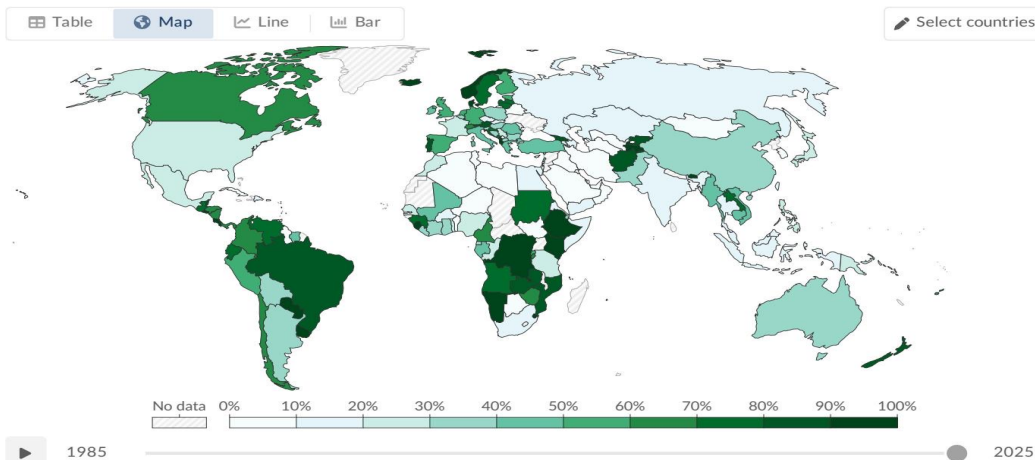
Almost One-Third of Global Electricity Now Comes from Renewables

Globally, almost one-third (~30%) of electricity comes from renewable sources (2025).

Share of electricity production from renewables, 2025

Renewables include solar, wind, hydropower, bioenergy, geothermal, wave, and tidal sources.

Our World
in Data

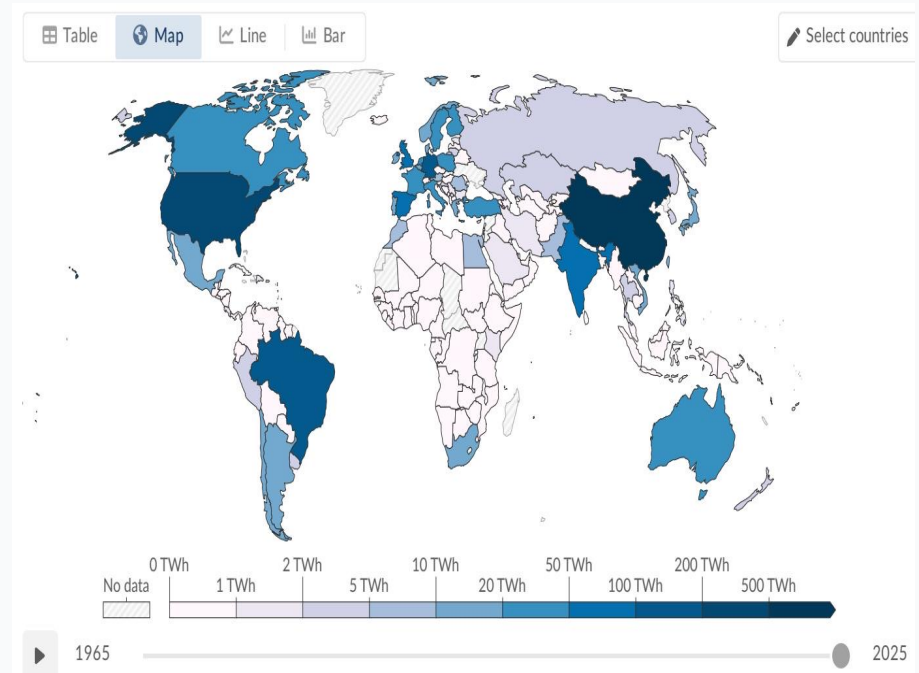


Data source: Ember (2026); Energy Institute - Statistical Review of World Energy (2025) – [Learn more about this data](#)
OurWorldinData.org/energy | CC BY

Country/Region	Renewable Share
Norway	~98%
Brazil	~85%
Canada	~65%
China	~35%
India	~25%
Saudi Arabia	<2%

Hydropower Remains the Largest Renewable Source at ~50% of Generation

- Hydropower accounts for roughly half of all renewable electricity globally.
- It has been generating electricity at scale for over a century.
- Top producers include China, Brazil, and Canada.



Wind and Solar Are the Fastest-Growing Energy Technologies in History

Wind Energy

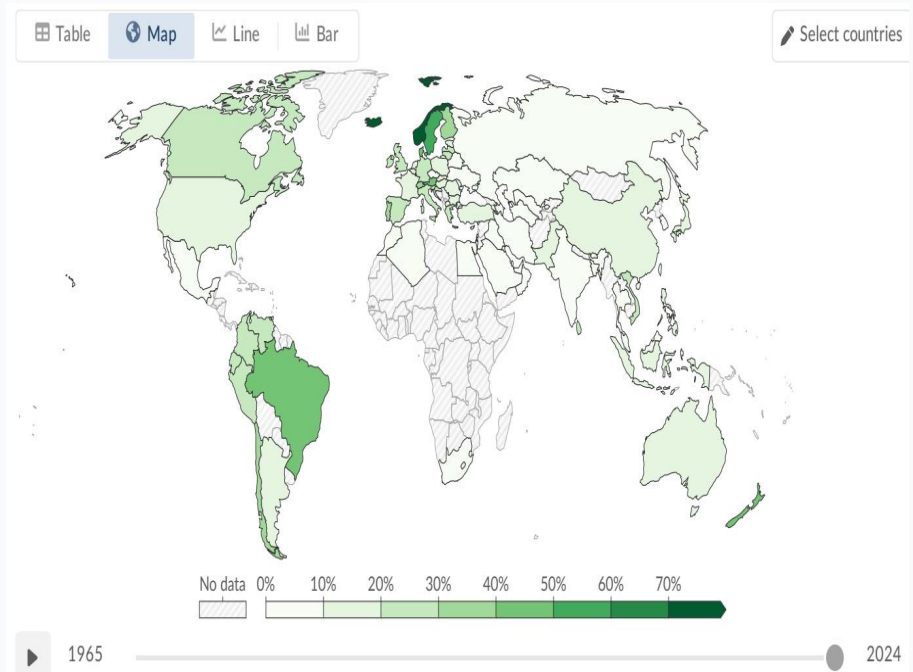
~2,400 TWh
(~25% of renewable electricity)

Solar Energy

~2,000 TWh
(~21% of renewable electricity)

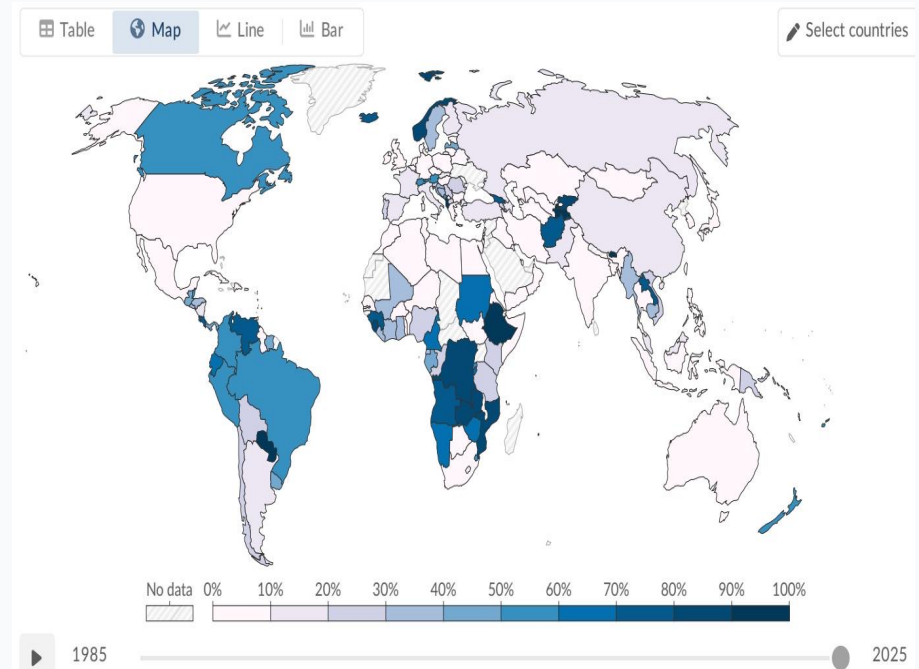
Combined, wind and solar now nearly match hydropower output.

Source: Our World in Data – Renewable Energy



Stark Regional Gaps: Sub-Saharan Africa Lags While Scandinavia and Latin America Lead

- Scandinavian countries and Brazil lead (65–98%), benefiting from abundant hydropower.
- Denmark and Germany have invested heavily in wind and solar.
- Sub-Saharan Africa has minimal renewable electricity infrastructure (<10%).
- Middle Eastern nations remain almost entirely fossil-fuel dependent (<2%).



Key Takeaways: Renewables Are Growing Fast but the Transition Must Accelerate

- **Milestones:** ~14% of primary energy and ~30% of global electricity now come from renewables.

Technology: Hydro is still dominant, but wind and solar are catching up rapidly.

Geography: Significant regional disparities persist globally.

Sector Gaps: Transport and heating lag far behind electricity in decarbonization.

To meet climate targets, the pace of the global energy transition must accelerate significantly.